

Store Passing and Boxes

CS 350

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March 25, 2025

Overview

Curly-Box: A Language with Mutation

Interpreting Boxes

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- Objectives

Store Passing Interpreters

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Curly-Box: A Language with Mutation

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- The value of the second expression is the value of the whole seq expression

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 - 10, since we updated its value

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 - do `set-box!` on it
 - After function, new value will be seen

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- By using a purely functional approach, we define a semantics for Curly, even if it has mutation
- The semantics is informal, but still a useful tool for *understanding* stateful programs and languages

New Abstract Syntax

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```
(define-type Exp
  ...
  ;; Create a new box with the given value
  (boxE [e : Exp])
  ;; Write the given value to the given box
  (set-box!E [theBox : Exp]
             [valToWrite : Exp])
  (unboxE [theBox : Exp])
  (seqE [eFirst : Exp]
        [eSecond : Exp])
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 - We store locations as numbers, but that's an implementation detail

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 - Purely functional *implementation language*

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- Get the value at the given location
 - Finds the first one in the list e.g. from the most recent `override-store`

Store Operations: new-loc

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(define (new-loc [sto : Store])  
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  (+ 1 (max-loc sto)))  
  
(define (max-loc [sto : Store])  
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- Get a new Location that does not yet have a value in the store
 - max-loc is a helper that enables this
 - Gets the list of all locations in the store
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- Used with override-store to extend a store to a new one with an additional location

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 - And take Store as argument

```
(define-type-alias Result
  (Value * Store))

(define (v*s [v : Value]
            [s : Store]) : Result
  (pair v s))

(define (interp [env : Env]
                [e : Exp]
                [sto : Store]) : Result ....)
```

Updating The Interpreter: Plus

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```
(define (interp [env : Env]
                [e : Exp]
                [sto : Store]) : Result
  (type-case Exp e
    [(Plus l r)
     (type-case Result (interp l env sto)
       [(v*s v-l sto-l)
        (type-case Result (interp r env sto-l)
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 - Design choice: which operand we eval first makes a difference

Aside: Racket Macros

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- `define-type` and `type-case` are both Racket macros
- The entire Flit type system is implemented with Racket macros

A Macro for Interpreting with Stores

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```
(define-syntax with
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 - Macros extend the syntax of a language using the language itself
 - Macros are code that is run at compile-time

Why Bother With a Macro

- Makes code shorter

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- Makes code shorter
- Makes intent clearer
 - “Interpret this code, then give a name to the value and store that result”

Using Our Macro

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```
(define (interp [env : Env]
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  (type-case Exp e
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     (with [(v-l sto-l) (interp env l sto)]
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- Much more succinct: call `interp`, and immediately give a name to the store and value we get as a result

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 - See in-class Racket if time permits

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 - So it *starts* with the store that left *returned*

Order Example

```
{let1 {b {box 3}}  
  {+ {seq {set-box! b {* 3 {unbox b}}}  
      5}  
    {unbox b}}}
```

- The first + argument is a seq expression

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- Final result 14

Boxes as Values

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```
(define-type Value
  (numV [num : Number])
  (boolV [bool : Boolean])
  (closureV [arg : Symbol]
            [body : Exp]
            [env : Env])
  (boxV [loc : Location]))
```

Interpreting Box

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```
(define (interp [env : Env]
                [e : Exp]
                [sto : Store]) : Result
  (type-case Exp e
    ...
    [(boxE a)
     (with [(v sto-v) (interp env a sto)]
       (let ([l (new-loc sto-v)])
         (v*s (boxV loc)
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- Interpret the value we're putting in the box

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- Interpret the value we're putting in the box
 - And get the store from this interpretation
- Create a new store that has the value at a new address
- Return the box with the new location
 - Return store is the store with the new location and value

Interpreting Unbox

```
[(unboxE a)
 (with [(v sto-v) (interp env a sto)]
  (type-case Value v
    [(boxV l) (v*s (lookup l sto-v)
                    sto-v)]
    [else (error 'interp "not a box")]))])
```

- Interpret the expression to a value

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 - Get the value and the store from this, since it might have had side effects

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 - Get the value and the store from this, since it might have had side effects
- Check if the value is a Box
 - Type error otherwise
- Get its location, and produce whatever value was at that location
 - With the store from evaluating the box

Interpreting Set-box!

Interpreting Set-box!

```
[(set-box!E bx val)
 (with [(v-b sto-b) (interp bx env sto)]
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 - Could have also returned dummy value 0, #t, etc.

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- Interpret the box to a value
 - Get the store from this execution
- Interpret the expression to be stored to a value
 - In the store we previously computed, getting a new store
- Check that the box value is actually a box
- Return the other value, *in the new store with the box location overwritten*
 - Could have also returned dummy value $\emptyset$, $\#t$, etc.
 - Purpose is the side effect

Interpreting Seq

```
[(seqE l r)
 (with [(v-l sto-l) (interp env l sto)]
  (interp env r sto-l))]
```

- Evaluate the first expression *but do nothing with the value*

Interpreting Seq

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[(seqE l r)
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  (interp env r sto-l))]
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 - Just get the store that's the result of evaluating it

Interpreting Seq

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[(seqE l r)
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  (interp env r sto-l))]
```

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 - Just get the store that's the result of evaluating it
- Evaluate the second expression *in the store the first returned*

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- Environments enable *static scope*

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 - Linearly threaded through the program
 - Once we've updated a store (by generating a new one), we *never use the old store again*
 - ... unless we implement more advanced features e.g. undo, backtracking